

Database Incident Response Runbook

This runbook covers responding to a database incident in production: connection exhaustion, replication lag, and a primary failover. It is distinct from the cache runbook.

Connection exhaustion: when the pool is saturated, new requests time out. Raise the pool ceiling, kill idle-in-transaction sessions, and shed non-critical background jobs.

Replication lag and failover

Replication lag: if a read replica falls behind by more than thirty seconds, route reads back to the primary until the replica catches up. Alert the on-call database engineer.

Primary failover: promote the healthiest replica, repoint the connection string, and run a post-incident review within two business days. Record the timeline in the incident log.